

HOW INTELLIGENT TOILETS CAN BRING EFFICIENT PUBLIC TOILET MANAGEMENT IN INDIA

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The invention of intelligent toilets has been creating quite a ripple across the globe, considering their smart capabilities to gather insights into public health and diseases. A few months back, Numi 2.0, an advanced intelligent toilet, was recognised in the smart home category at the 2020 International Consumer Electronics Show (CES) Awards held in Las Vegas.

Talking about India, the state of public toilets is in a deplorable condition. Maintenance and sustainability of public toilets are among the biggest challenges across the country. Despite their several benefits, not many are aware of smart toilets. The intelligent toilet is still an untapped area, and this technology is yet to hit the mainstream in the country.

This article explores how intelligent toilets can help in mitigating the most neglected issues concerning public toilets.

Public toilet challenges in India

It is undeniable that poor public sanitation is one of the major concerns in India. Many do not

have access to safe and private toilets till date. This is not a case that one witnesses only in remote villages, but also in the cities. It is a major concern for the country as human waste breeds various diseases and contributes to environmental pollution that kills nearly one thousand children each day. To contain the matter, the Swachh Bharat Mission was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on October 2, 2014, which has made India open defecation-free to a large extent.

Under the mission, it has been

reported that over 95 million toilets have been built across the country. The pressing problem is the upkeep and maintenance of these toilets. There is no mechanism to provide clear insights into water usage, hygiene conditions, infectious diseases, the number of people using the toilets, etc. In such a scenario, utilising the Internet of Things (IoT) enabled technologies can bring effectiveness in the whole operation and change the perception about Indian public toilets.

Toilet maintenance is indeed com-



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